

Matter Prep

SOCIAL JUSTICE & MOVEMENTS

- **Purpose**
 - To achieve social justice for marginalized groups, for groups who need certain sets of rights
 - Comprises individuals, leaders, companies, support groups, NGOs, etc.
- **What does every movement want?**
 - People
 - **Vulnerable, most marginalized people**, most affected by an issue and in need of a solution to the most
 - **Leaders of the movement**, who carry out all advocacy, spokespersons of the movement who represent its interests publicly, lobby with companies and governments
 - **External supporters**, who sympathize with the cause but aren't directly affected, provide donations and other kinds of support
 - **What does it not want?**
 - Internal Disagreements between these people
 - Putting these people in harm's way
 - **What does this help in achieving?**
 - Political capital and leverage: the more people a movement is supported by, the more pressure an oppressive structure is under to budge and provide concessions
 - Spreading the word: Others seeing a movement being backed by so many people, makes them curious about the cause, helps in raising awareness about the cause
 - Safety net: The government can't put you behind bars so easily, lesser threat of state crackdown

- Institutional Support
 - **Corporations/Companies** backing a movement, sympathetic with the cause, want good PR or competing with other companies who are backing other movements
 - **Non Governmental Organisations**, which raise funds through voluntary donations, provide support to vulnerable people through relief aid and support
 - **Political Support**, often by Opposition Political groups who want to oppose the government in power because of ideological differences, or simply politically opposing whatever the government does
 - **What does it not want?**
 - Direct opposition from institutions, leads to a loss of legitimacy, massive public backlash
 - **What does this help in achieving?**
 - Sustainable Policy Making and Revenue
 - Massive legitimacy
- **Different types of Social Justice Movements**
 - Feminist Movement
 - Marital Rights: Abortion, Contraception, Against Marital Rape
 - Economic Rights: Equal Pay and Minimum Wage, Workplace Discrimination
 - Social Rights: Voting, Affirmative Action and Quotas, Minimum Free Education
 - Awareness
 - LGBTQ Movement
 - Marital Rights: The right to marry
 - Social Rights: Affirmative Action and Quotas in public and private spaces, awareness
 - Creation of support groups
 - Subsidising and reducing stigma around Conversion Therapy
 - Environment Movement
 - Global Environmental Awareness

- Lobbying against polluters (Big shell companies, oil producers and exporters around the world), sustainable environment friendly policies
- Push towards Renewable Sources of Energy (Solar, Geothermal, Hydroelectric, Nuclear), against fossil fuels
- Animal Rights Movement
 - Awareness
 - Safer breeding conditions and facilities for poultry animals
 - Against poaching and game hunting
- Labour Unions
 - Changes in Corporate policies, Equal Pay, Maternity Leave

THP leaderless SJMs

- **Identifying an impact:** How does the motion affect the stakeholder, exclusively (try creating a rough sketch in your head)
 - UNITY, Lesser fracturing In the movement
 - People's perception, view you more legitimate
 - Clear message, lack of clarity when too many people are talking
 - Optimised, sequential, focussed efforts
- **Setup:** What sort of places the debate takes place in, what sort of stakeholders the debate affects, etc.
 - Multiple factions, representative of each faction to negotiate with the government
 - Different contexts, different social backgrounds hence different requirements
 - Loud ones are more prevalent, so you need a moderating influence
 - Tendency of humans
 - Hero worship, need someone to be inspired and leaders keep people motivated to stay because people idolize them so much
- **Providing mechanisms:** What are the ways in which the motion achieves the impact
 - Highly dedicated, will be held accountable

- Larger picture, balance of interests
 - Liasioning, being the middleman between different factions
 - Infighting for power, to claim legitimacy
- INCENTIVES OF LEADERS
 - Remaining in power (money, reputation, political capital, negotiation power with the government)
- **Scale of impact:** Establishing how significant of an impact you are achieving relative to your opposing team
- **Weighing:** Establishing why the impact you achieve is the most important thing in the debate

PHILOSOPHY AND NARRATIVES

- APPROACH

- **Be very careful with motion wording**

- THS the narrative that people should remain content with that they have in life
 - THS the premium placed on being content
 - THP a world in which everyone was content with what they have

- **Never overestimate/under-estimate impacts of such motions**

- Some motions have really small impacts
 - Some motions have really big impacts

- NARRATIVES

- **Some Motion Examples**

- THS the “snail girl” narrative among working women
 - THR the stigmatization of insecurity within long term relationships
 - THO the premium placed on being content
 - THO the glorification of discipline
 - THO the romanticisation of adoption

- **Basic To-Dos**

- Some stakeholders (in some cases most stakeholders) will be unaffected on either side of the debate
 - It's crucial to explain:
 - Who creates the narrative, or who is the source of the narrative
 - Who does the narrative affect exclusively
 - How is change that the narrative is bringing uniquely crucial from the general existence of the concept in SQ
 - Debate Meta:
 - The barrier of a narrative might keep increasing or decreasing dependent on the above 3 factors
 - A version of the narrative might coexist with general narratives, another version of a narrative might not be able to coexist

- PHILOSOPHY

- **Some Motion Examples**

- THBT individuals have a moral obligation to the law
- Assuming the technology exists, THS a world where the Empathy Gun exists and is widely accessible
- THW allow individuals to change their race
- THW rather not be a born
- This House prefers a "Brave New World" to the status quo in Western Liberal Democracies
 - A “Brave New World” has these characteristics:
 - People are genetically engineered and socially conditioned by the state for specific societal roles.
 - People's material and physical needs are unfailingly met.
 - There is no possibility of changing the social order.
- **Basic To-Dos**
 - Higher Impact Motions, tend to affect a significantly greater number of people than narrative motions
 - Not as tricky
 - Lesser strategizing required than narrative motions
 - Affect humans on a psychological level, so always think about how you will feel if you were put in the position of the motion

RELIGION MOTIONS

- **Very multi dimensional theme**

- Individual belief systems - the concept of personal sacrifice (self sacrificial religions), individual belief systems (agnosticism, atheism), conservative belief systems (homophobia, the concept of Liberation Theology), influence from parents, faith based therapy
- Community level belief systems - isolated religious communities (conservatives communities in Jainism), communal punishments and social ostracisation, sectarian differences in religions (shia vs sunni in islam)
- Inter religious dynamics - religious differences (Hindu vs Muslim), ethnic and religious conflicts, proselytisation
- Relationship with the state - civilian vs religious courts, religious personal laws (triple talaq, Uniform Civil Code, Sabarimala)
- Internal religious dynamics - religious priests and leaders, donations, political influence

- **Broad things to keep in mind:**

- Religion Motions always have lots of impacts - very important to prioritise which one to run
- Teams often heavily disagree on how belief systems are framed - the intent behind creating these belief systems, who created belief systems, who controls belief systems. Winning the contextualisation battle can be very helpful to win debates.

- **MOTION EXAMPLE**

- This house believes that the LGBT+ movement should prioritize promoting a narrative of reinterpretation of religions, rather than promoting a narrative against religions.

- This house prefers religions where foundational religious figures are seen as morally flawed instead of morally perfect
- This house prefers a world where religions portray their deities as being completely uninvolved in the universe after creating it rather than actively involved in the universe
- This house prefers a world where all major religions did not obligate their followers to go on religious pilgrimages
- This house prefers a world where religions teach that divine rewards (e.g., blessings, good karma) are received during one's earthly life rather than in the afterlife.
- In countries with significant religious diversity, THBT states should push for the abolishment of Religious Personal Law (Religious personal law is a set of legal principles and regulations that govern personal and family matters according to the tenets of a particular religion, different from civil laws of a nation)
- In countries with significant religious divides, THW ban missionary schools
- In places with historical disputes around an existing religious structure, THS the implementation of the 'places of worship' act (For the purposes of this debate, The 'places of worship act' freezes the religious identity of places of worship of each religion, and prevents the destruction of existing religious structures)